Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 7
♥ 6
♦ A Q 10 8 7 5
♣ A 10 6

♠ 10 9 5 4 3
♥ A Q 9
♦ 2
♣ 9 5 4 3

♠ 8 6 2
♥ K J 8 5 3 2
♦ 9 4
♣ 8 2

♠ A Q
♥ 10 7 4
♦ K J 6 3
♣ K Q J 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♦		
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

6♦ by North
Lead: ♣8

Partner's 3♦ bid shows a very good hand with probable slam interest. It is very tempting to say 3NT now but you don't have ♥s stopped and don't know if partner does. So with good ♦ support you bid 4♦. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠A and ♦K. But you don't have the ♦Q so you answer 5♥. Partner bids 6♦.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 3 ♥ 7 ♦ 9 8 6 5 4 2 ♣ J 9 4 3	
♠ A 6 5 2 ♥ Q J 5 2 ♦ K J 3 ♣ 8 2		♠ K 10 8 ♥ A K 9 8 6 4 ♦ — ♣ A K Q 7
	♠ Q 9 7 4 ♥ 10 3 ♦ A Q 10 7 ♣ 10 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♣[2]	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by East
Lead: ♠7

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠A or the practically useless ♦A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠A. It looks like the slam is a good idea so you say 6♥.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K 8 6 5 2 ♥ K J 10 7 ♦ — ♣ A 9 8 3	
♠ 10 3 ♥ Q 9 2 ♦ K Q 8 7 5 ♣ 10 7 2	N W E S	♠ J ♥ A 6 5 4 3 ♦ J 10 9 4 ♣ 6 5 4
	♠ A Q 9 7 4 ♥ 8 ♦ A 6 3 2 ♣ K Q J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by South
Lead: ♦K

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 3 2 ♥ J 3 2 ♦ 8 7 6 4 3 ♣ 8 4 3	
♠ K Q J ♥ A 10 7 6 ♦ A Q J ♣ Q J 9	N W E S	♠ A 10 8 ♥ K 9 8 4 ♦ K 9 ♣ K 10 6 5
	♠ 9 7 6 5 4 ♥ Q 5 ♦ 10 5 2 ♣ A 7 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2NT	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♥[2]			
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards without the trump queen

5♥ by West
Lead: ♠3

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.